



Tweaking Agency

Google Ads That Actually Work

Joey Stiver — PR media target research

Client: **Joey Stiver**

Date: **2026-06-23**

29 targets · 3 pitch angles

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Executive summary

Joey Stiver (joeystiver.com) bootstrapped a mid-nine-figure healthcare portfolio (Amble, MinuteMD, Vaxxen Labs, MedLab) from an **\$8,000 credit card** after a federal conviction — with no venture capital and a 12-year pristine telehealth compliance record. He leads the Joey Stiver Foundation and the **St. Dismas Accelerator**, piloting AI-driven entrepreneurship training for formerly incarcerated adults in Ohio and Puerto Rico.

PITCH ANGLE	TARGETS
Bootstrapping	16
The \$8k Comeback	5
The St. Dismas Accelerator	8
Total	29

Top 5 pitch-first contacts

1. **Tom Huddleston Jr.** (CNBC Make It) — Founder comeback profiles with bootstrap capital details.
2. **Graham Winfrey** (Inc.) — Startup section editor; Inc 5000 / founder-led growth.
3. **Greg Head** (Practical Founders) — Bootstrapped operator podcast; hyper-personalized pitch only.
4. **Will Davis** (WYSO) — Ohio reentry audio storytelling successor to ReEntry Stories.
5. **Christine Lagorio-Chafkin** (Inc.) — Editor-at-Large; deep founder features and *From the Ground Up* podcast.

Pitchable targets: 26 · **Do not pitch:** 3 (see PR manager exclusions)

Angle 1 — Bootstrapping

Tier-1 business / mainstream: no-VC scaling, telehealth portfolio growth, Inc 5000-style operational grit.

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST & TITLE	CONTACT	BYLINE	RECENT WORK	ANGLE	WHY FIT
CNBC Make It	Ashton Jackson <i>Success Reporter</i>	ashton.jackson@versantmedia.com	Author page	\$16K bootstrap to \$90K/mo; FarmboxRx CEO	BOOTSTRAPPING	Profiles self-funded founders scaling without outside capital — mirrors Joey's \$8K reinvestment path.
CNBC Make It	Tom Huddleston Jr. <i>Senior Entrepreneurs Reporter</i>	tom.huddleston@versantmedia.com	Author page	Bankruptcy to \$1B; \$14K seed to \$3.8M	BOOTSTRAPPING	Deep founder profiles with explicit bootstrap mechanics (credit cards, no VC). Joey's unbankable restart is a stronger version of stories he already publishes.
Entrepreneur	Amanda Breen <i>Senior Features Writer</i>	abreen@entrepreneur.com	Author page	Doctor's \$100M health business; Self-funded 7 figures	BOOTSTRAPPING	Long-form healthcare founder features. Amble outcomes + portfolio give her a doctor-founder + bootstrap dual hook.
Entrepreneur UK	Patricia Cullen <i>Features Writer</i>	patricia.cullen@bncb2b.com	Author page	UK founder/innovation features (HARO: short query, title in subject)	BOOTSTRAPPING	International entrepreneur profiles with solutions lens. Joey's compliance-heavy empire is a strong US founder feature.
Fast Company	Ainsley Harris <i>Senior Writer</i> ⚠️ departing	aharris@fastcompany.com	Author page	Innovative fintech 2025	BOOTSTRAPPING	Hard-startup/innovation profiles. Pitch before Fast Company exit; frame Amble Cares GLP-1 affordability.

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST & TITLE	CONTACT	BYLINE	RECENT WORK	ANGLE	WHY FIT
Forbes	Alison Coleman <i>Senior Contributor</i>	alison@alisoncoleman.co.uk	Author page	Art of Bootstrapping	BOOTSTRAPPING	Dedicated bootstrapping beat for Forbes Entrepreneurs. Joey's no-VC path to \$1B+ is her core thesis.
Fortune	Indrani Sen <i>Senior Editor, Features</i> — lower priority	indrani.sen@fortune.com	Author page	Change the World; Gates health R&D	BOOTSTRAPPING	Magazine features editor — pitch only for long-form Fortune healthcare access feature (Amble Cares).
Fortune	Matthew Heimer <i>Executive Editor</i> ⚠️ departing Jun 2026	matt.heimer@fortune.com	Author page	Change the World list; longform features	BOOTSTRAPPING	Led Change the World franchise. Pitch only with urgency before departure.
Grit Daily	Spencer Hulse <i>Editorial Director</i>	spencer@gritdaily.com	Author page	Startup/innovation; SXSW founder panels	BOOTSTRAPPING	Millennial/Gen Z startup hub. Low priority — paid-to-play outlet, lower traffic. Possible LLM citation upside only; do not pitch as earned media without PR approval.
Inc.	Graham Winfrey <i>Deputy Digital Editor</i>	gwinfrey@inc.com	Author page	Founder-Friendly Investors 2025	BOOTSTRAPPING	Oversees Inc startup section. Joey's Inc 5000-caliber growth without VC is a flagship Inc narrative.
Inc.	Nick Hawkins <i>Assistant Web Producer</i>	nhawkins@inc.com	Author page	Farmer's Fridge narrative ; Inc 5000	BOOTSTRAPPING	Inc 5000 and lean-startup credibility pieces. "Bulletproof compliance after a felony" is a trust story.
Inc.	Tim Crino <i>Senior Editor</i>	tcrino@inc.com	Author page	Inc 5000 C-suite panel	BOOTSTRAPPING	Edits Inc Insider; covers growth-stage operators and Inc 5000 ecosystem.

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST & TITLE	CONTACT	BYLINE	RECENT WORK	ANGLE	WHY FIT
Entrepreneur	Leo Zevin <i>Contributing Writer</i> — lower priority	leozevin@gmail.com	Author page	Athlete/celebrity entrepreneur profiles	BOOTSTRAPPING	Beat is athlete founders — deprioritize unless sports/wellness crossover.
Inc.	Christine Lagorio-Chafkin <i>Editor-at-Large</i>	lagorio@gmail.com	Author page	Inc features; co-hosted <i>From the Ground Up</i>	BOOTSTRAPPING	Deep founder features. Joey's decade-long operational memoir is magazine-length.
STAT	Katie Palmer <i>Health Tech Correspondent</i>	katie.palmer@statnews.com	Staff page	GLP-1 gold rush ; FDA telehealth warnings	BOOTSTRAPPING	Documents telehealth scale + scrutiny. 🚫 Do not pitch — writes critically of GLP-1 spaces, businesses, and CEOs (PR manager 2026-06-23).
Fierce Healthcare	Heather Landi <i>Executive Editor</i>	FierceHealthcare@questex.com	About	Hims & Hers GLP-1 ; telehealth team lead	BOOTSTRAPPING	Runs Fierce telehealth vertical six years. 🚫 Do not pitch — mainly covers big pharma; do not tread on that beat (PR manager 2026-06-23).

Angle 2 — The \$8k Comeback

Entrepreneurship podcasts: raw operational reality, systemic blockades (unbankable), credit-card-funded empire.

PODCAST	HOST & TITLE	CONTACT	SHOW URL	RECENT EPISODES	ANGLE	WHY FIT
Practical Founders	Greg Head <i>Host</i>	Contact form → Podcast guest recommendation	Show	Bootstrapped founders \$20M–\$100M+ without big funding	\$8K COMEBACK	Entire franchise is no-VC operators. Personalize heavily — Greg rejects generic AI pitches.
The Bootstrap	Scotty Allen <i>Host, The Product Bus</i>	scott@theproductbus.com	thebootstrap.tech	Weekly bootstrapping news + operator tactics	\$8K COMEBACK	Show is explicitly for founders with “no external investors.” Joey's 3 AM post office runs are peak Bootstrap content.

PODCAST	HOST & TITLE	CONTACT	SHOW URL	RECENT EPISODES	ANGLE	WHY FIT
The Human Challenge	Vanessa Ferlaino <i>Host & Producer</i>	Contact form	Show page	Comeback Snacks / prison	\$8K COMEBACK	Documents systemic barriers + entrepreneurship. Joey's conviction and \$8K restart mirror her incarceration-to-CEO episodes.
Stigma Podcast	Stephen Hays <i>Host, What If Ventures</i>	info@whatif.vc	Show page	Business from prison	\$8K COMEBACK	Stigmatized healthcare + second-chance founders. Joey built compliant telehealth after a felony — rare arc for his audience.
From That Comes This	Rebecca Foster <i>Host</i>	Substack	Show	Prison to purpose	\$8K COMEBACK	Comeback narrative format (pain → purpose). Natural follow to her Emily O'Brien episode; Hamilton ON is Ohio-adjacent.

Angle 3 — The St. Dismas Accelerator

Ohio & Puerto Rico impact media: faith-driven leadership, reentry-through-tech, Joey Stiver Foundation.

Do not pitch Mary Evans (WYSO ReEntry Stories creator) — deceased June 2025. Route to Will Davis / communityvoices@wyso.org. Dayton Daily News Community Impact Editor role eliminated Jan 2026 — use WYSO or ddnnews@coxinc.com.

OUTLET	JOURNALIST & TITLE	CONTACT	BYLINE	RECENT WORK	ANGLE	WHY FIT
WYSO	Will Davis <i>Director, Community Voices</i>	wdavis@wyso.org	Community Voices	ReEntry Stories legacy; community audio training	ST. DISMAS	Leads center that produced ReEntry Stories. St. Dismas Ohio pilot = natural audio documentary.
WYSO	Neenah Ellis <i>Senior Producer</i>	communityvoices@wyso.org	Community Voices	Founded Community Voices; edited ReEntry Stories	ST. DISMAS	Built WYSO's community storytelling infrastructure — editorial gatekeeper for Miami Valley impact audio.
El Nuevo Día	Sharon Minelli Pérez <i>Startups & Innovation Reporter</i>	sharon.perez@gfrmedia.com	Author page	PR startup ecosystem	ST. DISMAS	Covers PR accelerator ecosystem. Joey lives in PR; St. Dismas pilot is local innovation + impact.

OUTLET	JOURNALIST & TITLE	CONTACT	BYLINE	RECENT WORK	ANGLE	WHY FIT
El Nuevo Día	Marian Díaz <i>Business Reporter</i>	marian.diaz@gfrmedia.com	El Nuevo Día Negocios	Local startup features	ST. DISMAS	SME/founder journeys. Frame St. Dismas as entrepreneurship-as-reentry infrastructure.
El Nuevo Día	Joanisabel González <i>Business & Economy Reporter</i>	Newsroom / LinkedIn	El Nuevo Día	Emprendimiento boricua; Echar Pa'lante summit	ST. DISMAS	Covers PR entrepreneurial economy — St. Dismas aligns with ecosystem-building she reports.
cleveland.com	Kaitlin Durbin <i>Reporter</i>	metrodesk@plaind.com	Staff page	Reentry Awareness Month	ST. DISMAS	Covers Ohio reentry workforce barriers. St. Dismas tech-entrepreneurship model is a solutions story.
cleveland.com	Cory Shaffer <i>Public Impact Reporter</i>	metrodesk@plaind.com	LinkedIn	Criminal justice enterprise; 8+ years courts beat	ST. DISMAS	Criminal justice + community impact across Northeast Ohio. Policy-meets-entrepreneurship angle.
Ideastream	Matthew Richmond <i>Reporter/Producer</i>	newsstaff@ideastream.org	Staff page	OSPJ Best Criminal Justice Reporting 2022–23	ST. DISMAS	Ideastream criminal justice reporter. St. Dismas as Ohio workforce/reentry innovation for public radio.

PR manager exclusions (2026-06-23)

CONTACT / OUTLET	STATUS	RATIONALE
Katie Palmer (STAT)	🚫 Avoid	Writes very critically of GLP-1 spaces, businesses, and CEOs — high reputational risk.
Heather Landi (Fierce Healthcare)	🚫 Avoid	Mainly covers big pharma; do not tread on that beat.
Grit Daily (Spencer Hulse)	Low / paid-to-play	Paid placement, lower traffic. Possible LLM citation upside only — not earned media.
thesurvivalpodcast.com (Jack Spirko)	🚫 Avoid	Completely avoid — do not send any communication (global exclusion).

Starter list notes

JOURNALIST	STATUS	ACTION
All 13 sheet emails	Verified	Use as listed

JOURNALIST	STATUS	ACTION
Matthew Heimer	Departing Fortune Jun 2026	Pitch with urgency or skip
Indrani Sen	Features editor	Lower priority
Ainsley Harris	Leaving Fast Company	Pitch immediately or skip
Leo Zevin	Athlete entrepreneur beat	Deprioritize
Katie Palmer (STAT)	Critical GLP-1 / CEO coverage	Do not pitch
Heather Landi (Fierce Healthcare)	Big pharma beat	Do not pitch
Grit Daily	Paid-to-play; low traffic	Low priority; LLM citation upside only
thesurvivalpodcast.com	Global exclusion	Do not contact
Mary Evans	Deceased Jun 2025	Route to Will Davis / communityvoices@wyso.org

Media list expansion strategy

For the Media Relations Manager — three adjacent sectors to expand next:

1. **Second-chance hiring / workforce DEI** — HR Executive, SHRM, WorkingNation. Joey's hiring philosophy and St. Dismas pipeline are HR-policy stories.
2. **Faith-driven business leadership** — Christianity Today Business, Relevant Podcast, Praxis Journal. Lead with operational ethics and second chances, not exclusively religious framing.
3. **DTC telehealth / GLP-1 access economics** — KFF Health News, Modern Healthcare. Amble Cares (up to 50% lower GLP-1 cost) is a policy hook for reporters who won't touch felony arcs. **Avoid STAT (Katie Palmer) and Fierce Healthcare (Heather Landi).**

Conversion & friction reduction strategy

1. **Headline-style subject lines** — e.g. EXCLUSIVE: Felony to \$1B — Ohio founder bootstrapped telehealth on \$8K credit card, zero VC
2. **4-bullet pitch block above the fold** — Hook · Proof points · Offer (interview, program access) · Ask (15-min call?)
3. **Link assets, never attach decks** — One-page fact sheet, founder photos, joeystiver.com on first touch.

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Source: [Google Sheet starter list](#)